

Aaron Scherf

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Over 7 years of experience implementing international development, foreign policy, data analytics, and applied empirical research. Led monitoring and evaluation for multi-billion dollar portfolios in Ukraine and Colombia, including cross-cutting design, budgeting, and stakeholder communication. Technical specializations in statistical analysis, geospatial technology, data visualization, and machine learning.

WORK EXPERIENCE

U.S. Agency for International Development

05/2019 – 07/2025

Foreign Service Officer – Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning Team Lead (FS 3–5)

Kyiv, Ukraine

- Directly managed \$36M contract for monitoring, evaluation, and learning services, including developing new systems for performance tracking, strategy alignment, and context research.
- Supervised implementation of 20 program evaluations, including leading design of a \$1.5M randomized control trial to evaluate impact of \$450M credit facilitation program for small businesses.
- Led collection of annual performance metrics and sectoral narratives for 52 development programs, aligning inter-agency indicator framework with new countrywide strategy and scorecard.
- Led team of 15 staff as acting Office Director and Budget Lead for 3 months during \$1.7Bn congressional funding negotiations and supervised over \$60M in realignment of program funds.
- Developed analytics system to track \$5Bn in electrical infrastructure support by administrative geography, enabling rapid repairs in response to Russian missile strikes and increased accountability.

Foreign Service Officer – Gender Equity and Program Design Officer (FS 4–9)

Bogota, Colombia

- Supported 32 programs to re-align performance indicators with gender equity and social inclusion principles, including multiple presentations to contract partner teams in Spanish.
- Led the design process for four new programs in smallholder agriculture, environmental conservation, and rural land titling, including developing indicators to measure job-expanding policy reforms.
- Developed data system to process and classify high-resolution drone imagery, resulting in over 600 new land titles issued to smallholder farmers in flood-prone areas in first 6 months.

Foreign Service Officer – Program Officer (FS 5–12)

Washington, DC, USA

- Won annual agency-wide award for developing budget data processing and visualization tool using Python and Tableau, saving hundreds of hours of staff time in negotiations with State Department.
- Led knowledge management pilot program with South Sudan office, including designing staff transition resources and implementation plan for improving handovers and file management in Juba.

Monitoring and Evaluation Specialist (Visiting Fellow)

Pretoria, South Africa

- Authored 200-page regional Gender Analysis report for 7 countries, synthesizing research on conditions for women, people with disabilities, and LGBTQI+ persons in Southern Africa.

Berkeley Food Institute

09/2019 – 03/2020

Agriculture and Hydrology Research Analyst

Berkeley, CA, USA

- Developed geospatial model analyzing groundwater and rainfall data compared with agricultural land-use for California's Central Valley, to support legislative reform and job-expansion programs.

Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW)

11/2017 – 07/2018

Graduate Research Fellow – Migration and Labor Economics

Mannheim, Germany

- Conducted statistical analysis of asylum seekers' education level and living conditions relation to employment outcomes using advanced econometric methods in Stata and data calls in SQL.
- Co-authored research paper in German on policy reform for refugee job placement in Rhine-Neckar region. Presented in German to city councils in Heidelberg and Mannheim.

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology

Master of Science in Computer Science • GPA: 3.88

Atlanta, GA, USA • 01/2022 – 12/2025

Indiana State University

Master of Science in Mathematics • GPA: 3.85

Terre Haute, IN, USA • 05/2021 – 05/2024

Thesis: Novel Omnibus Normality Test and Power Comparison with the Shapiro-Wilk

University of California, Berkeley

Master of Science in Development Practice • GPA: 3.94

Berkeley, CA, USA • 07/2018 – 05/2020

Thesis: Predicting the Yield of CIMMYT Wheat Genotypes via Remote Sensing and Machine Learning

Mercer University

Bachelor in International Finance and Economics • GPA: 3.91

Macon, GA, USA • 08/2013 – 05/2017

Exchange Semester at Linnaeus University in Kalmar, Sweden

Honors Thesis: Analyzing Regional Economic Impacts of Syrian Refugee Crisis in Turkey

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Donald M. Payne International Development Fellow (\$100,000 graduate fellowship)

05/2017

Humanity in Action Senior Fellow (in partnership with Amnesty International)

05/2017

Fulbright Scholar (Graduate Research Fellow in Heidelberg, DE)

05/2017

Stamps Foundation Leadership Scholar (\$240,000 undergraduate scholarship)

05/2013

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS & PUBLICATIONS

Autonomous Drone Deployment Grid for Improved Wildfire Response in California

05/2020

UC Berkeley: Innovations in Disaster Response Showcase

Applications of PCA for Mapping Regional Socioeconomic Vulnerability Indices

12/2019

UC Berkeley: Data for Human Mobility Lab

Integration Progress: Results from two Reallabor Surveys of Asylum Seekers

08/2018

Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW)

Published at: <https://www.econstor.eu/handle/10419/231442>

“OurBlock” – Blockchain Based Property Registry for South African Land Reform

03/2017

Harvard Social Entrepreneurship Pitch Competition

“How to Kill a Microfinance Fund” – Analysis of Microcredit Policy in South Africa

10/2016

Southern Conference Undergraduate Research Forum

“Peer2Peer” – Digital Marketplace for Asset-Collateralized Microcredit Exchange

06/2016

Thomson Reuters’ “Land Rights in Africa” Hackathon and Pitch Contest

SKILLS

Computer Programming and Artificial Intelligence

- Python, R, JavaScript
- Stata, MatLab, Excel
- Data Engineering / Processing
- Agentic AI (CrewAI / AutoGen)
- Artificial Neural Networks
- Machine Learning
- SQL, Azure, GCP

Applied Economic Research

- GIS Analysis (ArcGIS / GEE)
- Labor Economic Research
- Environmental Analysis
- Empirical Policy Analysis
- Development Economics
- Spatial Epidemiology
- Statistical Modeling
- Data Visualization

Languages and Other

- Spanish – Professional
- German – Intermediate
- Program Evaluation
- Contract Management
- Budget Management
- Report and Memo Writing
- Stakeholder Engagement
- Presentations and Training